Backup and Recovery Strategy for a Small Organisation

1. Objective

To protect organisational data from accidental deletion, hardware failure, cyberattacks, and data loss.

2. Backup Strategy: 3-2-1 Rule

- **3 copies:** Keep three copies of important data, including the original.
- **2 media types:** Store backups on two different types of storage.
- **1 offsite copy:** Keep one backup in a separate, secure location, such as encrypted cloud storage.

3. Backup Schedule

- Daily: Back up important files and documents.
- Weekly: Perform a full backup.
- Monthly: Review backup status and storage security.

4. Security Measures

- Encrypt backup files.
- Use strong passwords and multi-factor authentication.
- Restrict backup access to authorised staff.
- Protect backups from ransomware and unauthorised deletion.

5. Recovery Plan

1. Identify the cause of data loss.
2. Isolate affected systems if a cyberattack is suspected.
3. Select the latest clean backup.
4. Restore the data and verify its accuracy.
5. Record the recovery results.

6. Backup Testing

Test backups monthly by restoring sample files to a safe test location. Confirm that files open correctly and data is complete.

7. Conclusion

The 3-2-1 backup strategy improves data availability, reduces the risk of permanent data loss, and supports business continuity.